Meditations

Of a Christian Husband and Father

David West

Foreword

INTRO - 1974

Jesus, thank you that you are you, ever loving, ever fulfilled, ever one with the Father and Holy Spirit.

Thank you Jesus for creating the desire within me that I become like you.

Ursula and I thank you for You in us. Jesus stay with us, we have opened our doors to you. Walk in and be at home.

Bless you for the child may he/she grow in playfulness with the Child Jesus.

Chapter 1

Just You and I Lord

Dear Lord Jesus Christ, Here we are, just You and I. We are alone Lord so let us pour out our hearts to each other.

Walking with the Lord

Good Jesus, my mind is permanently thinking about You and how You would cope with the situations I am plunged into.

Dear Lord, sometimes I am terrified by the challenges

You put before me. I know You are urging me on, prompting me gently to come closer to You who are closeness itself. Does it matter to You much where I am Lord? You who look so gently upon me, urging me to refresh myself in the healing silence of Your loving gaze. It is so difficult, my friend Jesus, You accepted Your chalice and redeemed me.

It is Your love which carries me on its wings. Yet I have to look to seek, to knock, to find. I cannot always wait Lord. Like good friends, we must work together You and I.

I want to participate Lord in Your Holy will. Often times I am held back knowing it is You who lives in me.

Dear Jesus, however incredible the fact of You in me, I believe it. So who am I? Am I You and I? In which case, Jesus, we move on - us two.

Lord, do I see You everywhere? I must believe You live in all men. The amazing awareness of running into You Lord, everywhere I go, is far too great for me to comprehend. Where do You lodge Jesus, when You are with those who blaspheme, the arrogant, those who think they know so much. You, whose love eradicates pain. Where do You stay?

Dear Jesus, may I protect You from Your enemies? But it is us, not me, never me now Lord, You and I. What a beautiful refreshing thought Jesus. Which one of us speaks?

Dear Jesus, You sent Your Holy Spirit, one with You and the Father. Lord, I daren't think further; on my own? Where are we Jesus? Where does this union start and stop? Lord is the suggestion correct? Am I caught up by Your Grace in this oneness? If this is so Jesus and since neither You nor I want to leave Us, when do we part, if ever?

Jesus, the pain of this awareness is too much. What next? Where to? Dear Jesus, it is so good to be as You are.

Thank You, thank You and thank You again sweet

Jesus. How consoling it is for us to talk to each other through the medium of paper. Do I ever cease to be David in being with You Lord? This morning David eat my flesh and blood. Can this be so, Jesus? Can You speak through me in all reality of You in me and me in You? We can converse for ever more and people may, when they meet David, meet Jesus. Nothing, or everything, to do with David Jesus. What a wonderful thought! Why don't all who love You and know You in the Eucharist acknowledge they are really Michael Jesus and Ursula Jesus.

Chapter 2

Do We Ever Separate?

Dear Jesus, do we ever separate?

Lord, if we are always together, and You and I acknowledge this as being so, why do we offend You? Why do You allow Yourself to be offended within me? Are You the Me-You that is untouchable Lord, it is You singing in all of us, "We are one in the Spirit".

Jesus, the You in me comprehends all this. My mind pains me but if I throw the burden on David Jesus, Jesus David, one is caught up in the point of infinity where You are. Are we with each other sill Lord? Please let us stay with the healing that stems from You to me and returns to You in ME that is always intact.

Jesus, You live in us and also Your Holy Spirit. So if I believe this, I am a tabernacle of the Lord, a place where You one with the Trinity, live.

Jesus, the point of not being Holy is the point at which one does not recognise You in US. But Jesus, as I said, You and I want to stay together. We need not say 'goodnight' to each other. Do You also stay with me in my sleep Jesus?

Never have I been more conscious of Your presence than in our dreams.

Lord, work is a worry, can we do what pleases You-Me?

What a mystery all becomes when we relate to You Lord. From the Father, all that is good comes through You Jesus. Nothing can be better than us being here, talking to each other.

Working Together

Is there any need to speak? Do we not fuse better in silence?

One knows this in Faith and therefore fact, since reason obeys Faith and Faith, Reason at the point where You blend them into the oneness that is to be found in You. Are we to go on Being as We are? Jesus-David. Who is to be still and who is to know You are God? Jesus certainly knows it. David asks that You heal his unbelief otherwise accepting by Your Grace unquestioningly and in faith.

Jesus in me knows all. He is one with the Father.

Chapter 3

Talking to Mary

Dear Jesus, I have just been, as You know, to have a chat with our little Mother.

Why has she not said anything recently? Do You remember when she spoke to me in my dream about persecution? And asked me to follow her in procession? On her feast day too. Remember Our Lady of Lourdes at the Cathedral?

Was I amazed Jesus, to see it all come about within three hours. "Look after my children." Dear mummy, pray the Heart of Jesus beats within me and the hand I offer You moves to the rhythm of His desires and it will be so. I too find Jesus that my heart burns with a love for Your children. Often I beg the Holy Spirit to enflame me and I plead through You, Jesus, to our good father when I see what appears to me to be nothing but self assertion. Lord, if only You were as pushy as most people seem to be. But no, Jesus, You are silent and wait. You do not violate.

Your own will in the Father that all men should be free to choose. But if once we have prayed that You take over in

our life, surely You honour the choice. If we sometimes fall back on ourselves, You retrieve. So obviously, when the monkey settles on our back for a while, You must remember our choice of yesterday.

Chapter 4

The Jugglers

Dear Jesus, there seem to be some questions You do not answer, not yet in any case. I remember that lovely, lovely prophetic vision You gave me. It gives me such joy to recall it.

The one at the circus when You and I seemed to be gliding in the Spirit, doing the trapeze and the tight rope and suddenly those ominously beautiful jugglers, all in black appeared one behind the other. I watched in fascination but then Our enemy no longer hold my gaze for long. Suddenly Your Holy men appeared. They too were dazzling but it was different. Your good men left us entirely free emotionally and in every way. We watched as they unobtrusively moved in behind the others so it was black, white, black, white and white gently took over the Juggling act.

Do You aways move in so gently Jesus? The ones, his ones, never made a move but just stayed in endless unfruition. And so we juggled in Your Spirit Jesus, the Holy Spirit, and so we shall go on till, by Your goodness, I may yet

praise You for all eternity with all our lovely friends upon whom the Father smiles.

Chapter 5

Jesus and His Friends

Lord, You know I am in no way worthy yet You delight in lifting us up. You and Your friends Jesus.

Some, I have a feeling, gladden Your heart especially. I know You are waiting to retrieve sinners and there is great joy in heaven at the return of one.

Lord, when I think of Padre Pio and You know how Your work in him staggers me, I wonder if You're not indulging in some form of favouritism.

Yet when I think of this holy man and the preparation that must have gone into Your fashioning him to endure, with You to some degree, the ignominy of the cross, I wonder to what extent You were re-living Your passion in Our friend. Poor Padre Pio, how it must have bewildered him to see the world applauding the Jesus of the 20th century when his master and friend, You Jesus, endured rejection and crucifixion that the Will of the Father may be glorified. How humiliating it must have been, Lord, for him to listen to You.

Chapter 6

Creation

Jesus, how lovely Your gardens are. What splendour and dignity there is in Your creation. Lord, I look lovingly on all You have designed and see an artistry which could only have been, because You are. I perceive all I do because I have seen that which You entrusted into our care.

You at the root of the Tree of Life which is You in us are many woods and fields known only to You since You are

infinite creativity and the world can only reflect shapes but not the totality which is You.

How many songs must be sung eternally in our spiritual heart, Your Sacred Heart Jesus, which glows lovingly harmonising in melodious orchestration to a song unutterable. Sung in the secret corners of eternal bliss. What melody, what joy Jesus; I too join the chorus yet my lips and throat can never express or fashion the ever existent in You and You alone.

What bliss of solitude You must know in Your ever sharing self, always giving, always receiving, never destructive to the eternal flow of fusing streams of Fatherly, Motherly love. What peace one finds in You Jesus, sweet Jesus. All bend at the mention of Your name.

One yearns to know Your gaze. Surely You must be smiling, You are eternal hope. No one can detract from You. You are the eternal rock against whom the merciless sea may sweep, always obedient to Your authority. All creation submits at Your command yet never is one encroached upon or servile because the yearning to participate in Your Holy Will gives us our inheritance in accepting that which, from You to us, is endless giving, even Your command.

Chapter 7

Restoring Life

Lord Jesus, I hear Your words concerning Your friend Lazarus and I listen to Your Heart murmuring sweet sighs of joy at bringing him back to life to give glory to the Father.

Dear Jesus, how much kinder have You been to many like myself who have offered You many a kiss of betrayal, whose soul has been besmirched in such evil desires and so many sins of deep separation and yet Your yearning Heart drew us back to a point of friendship and laughter.

Lord what a great lover You are. How Your foster father, St. Joseph, must have drawn strength from Almighty God the Father who endlessly roams the hearts of men calling them back to Him in endless forgivingness for the unfaithful whims of our selfish desires.

Chapter 8

Correcting the 'Breech'

Thank You Jesus for the little child unborn whom You alone know. Sweet Jesus, at the speaking of words in Praise of You, he swivelled round for joy and is now in that position easiest for him to see the joy of birth into that gift of life which You have given him or her.

Thank You Jesus that already this child knows Your Healing Spirit and its spirit yields to Your love in that child, sensing Your Holy Presence which is so pleasing unto You.

We all bless and praise Your Holy name. Sweet Jesus, remain with us always otherwise what happens to David, Ursula and the little one.

Chapter 9

Deep Prayer Group Experience

Lord, how good You are. Sunday was really a question of being with You. How very mysteriously You work. I had half expected something new was being opened up but was not sure what. Everyone else here seemed to know Your presence. No howling out or loud prayers but the nearness of You was a blanketing of Your love. I could feel You flowing out of and into each one of us like a gentle, endless, tangible ripple of us here being connected with the praying world.

You are the light of the world

The moments of stillness opened up into a silence drawing us ever closer to the unspeakable, ever enfolding You. How lovely, Jesus, to see that all medical understanding and depth psychology stems from You. The acute sensitivity of being with You makes even a bell ringing seem to be like a dagger pushed through our inmost being. You are leading us on Lord into a serene calmness in You.

I can understand why the receptivity of a soul in moments of trance like prayer is acute and disturbing loud prayer literally jars on the nerves. One could practically feel Your anaesthetising love and one has to be so careful Jesus. The soul in these deep moments of opening up is so believing and an unhealthy prayer or thought communicated can be very damaging. Also Lord, at the point of leaving You, one is in an acutely sensitive state and needs a time of coming too. These stops and starts in prayers must be under Your guidance Jesus; please help us.

Chapter 10

The 'Laying on of Hands'

This 'laying on of hands', Jesus, one knows one is touching Your Heart in the innermost being of another person and Your Holy Spirit formulates thoughts or pictures about another at a given time You choose.

Dear Stewart, You had been telling me his leg trouble was to do with his fears but his conscious self could not remember any. Knowing how carefully You guide me Jesus, we persevered in prayer on Sunday with him for three hours then Your Holy Spirit showed a twelve year old in a little whirl pool with demons grinning hideously. Stewart remembered, Lord, that he nearly drowned at twelve and was saved, bleeding all over as the sea had dashed him against the boulders. His excessive water in the legs, due to a blockage, started shortly after. Now You've pinpointed the time Lord, will You stay with us for a complete healing?

Dear Jesus, it is so important that those who lay hands are sensitive to Your Spirit and test things before they speak out anything. Also, so much guess=work is subconsciously churned out.

Prayer must be in every thought and prayer means a consciousness of You rather than a projection of ourselves.

You have opened up a door to me Jesus, You walked into many years ago. What psychologists call 'the subconscious', is the area of us in which You gently move and battles rage.

We have to stay with Your words expressing 'Your Way' because it is so polluting to convey our own wordings and suggestions which very often mask our own fears.

Obedience to You is so essential and until we can accept every word of scripture, joyously, and not just the parts we like, we are open prey to the devil and his quoting You out of context. I must follow all You say closely Jesus, whether directly in scripture or to me or through others.

Please let Your wonderful mother be with us at the prayer group. I need all her help to keep up devotion to this loving weapon, the most Holy Rosary.

Chapter 11

Build us a Team

Please let Your wonderful mother be with us at the prayer group. I need all her help to keep up devotion to this loving weapon, the most Holy Rosary.

Also, Jesus, I want You to provide a team of people who will be prepared to come to You ever more closely and open up their all to receive and radiate Your light to others who need it.

Please let us set this in motion quickly. So many need

help dear Jesus, and protect this house with the cloak of Your mystery and prepare and consolidate those who You want to join You in this work.

It is so important for You to implant all Your thoughts on my heart, our heart, and please give me the courage and strength to walk the waters with each person we pray for. You assured me in that beautiful dream Lord that I had.

Now You tell me to do it for, and with, all those who are frightened. Since You had guided me, I know they will follow, if I stay with You.

Please, Jesus, I yearn to bring hundreds of thousands to You. Please let it be so I know You want me to. Ursula, You, the child and I, what a team we are Jesus. Bless You Jesus, son of God.

Chapter 12

The Healing of a Memory

Dear Lord, a gap, we haven't met on paper for sometime. I know it's not really important how, or where, we meet because it's not a question of me but US, You and I and all Your people. So extraordinary Your love can condense all into You. You reach out to all in a whisper and here we are doing it together.

Lord, thank You for the many blessings of the past two weeks. I can hardly believe so much has happened in such a short time. The enemy is cunning Jesus but You outwit him all the way. Poor Stewart, imagine being taken to a spiritualist for many years right up to last September and not knowing it.

Dear Jesus, did the forces really cloud his memory to use him at a later date? In suddenly making me remark about mothers innocently being led to do things which offend You, and then reminding me how harmful spiritualism was, You Jesus, opened the doors to his memory. Then Your radiant light shone as his memory was rekindled and he confessed to having been to a woman who uses a nun as a medium. Dear Jesus, who is this poor nun? Even then Jesus,

the enemy had lost because Stewart admitted that something was hindering his desire to be healed.

You Jesus, were waiting for the right time. Even then, Lord, the desire grew within him to join the monks at Fort Augustus and now sometime in September he shall join the monks.

One more intercessor for you Jesus, praying for a world that so needs your glow upon it. What a victory Jesus. You always win. Bless and praise Your Heavenly Father that you allow us, through you son, Jesus, to come to you holding out our hands, knowing we shall receive.

Chapter 13

Door to Teaching

Many thanks Jesus, for opening up this new door. I have thought about teaching for many years, yet this business of a certificate kept me away. What a great blessing learning is, Jesus.

I have spent the better part of my life marvelling at the gems of information one can pick up from those who act as though you do not exist. In your mercy however, you gift everyone of us to a degree. Yet your secrets you reveal only to those who love you and you alone. Earthly and spiritual vanity are so closely intermingled, that only those who aspire to be like you, Holy, can ever draw from the well of life which is You in Us.

You even put to good use, those caught up in spiritual pride who are trapped by signs and wonders. They seem to forget that your Heart yearns for man in all his humanity, yet you reach them at the point at which they are prepared to meet you. You, Jesus, are no respecter of definitions. You consider the supposedly ignorant, deceitful, cheats, blasphemers as your potential friends, speaking to them in a

language that will melt their hearts and allow them to yield graciously to your love in them and for them. How great thou art, dear Lord.

Chapter 14

Mediatrix

Dear little mother, you are so gentle. Your son, David, loves you greatly.

The way we recite your prayers, given by the Holy Spirit, allows all of us to reach out to you in that prayer from our Heavenly Father. This prayer, this salutation, recognises your role as mediatrix and co redemptorist with Jesus, your son, who treated you in the fullness of motherhood and completed your role in His abandonment to the Will of the Father.

Mary holding the child Jesus

Your grief, dear little mother, apart from what one expects, was caught up in your son's grief at not being recognised as being One with the Father. That man, caught up in darkness, was not acknowledging his heritage through the giving of your son at the request of the Father. What a beautiful union of sacrifice which in no way diminishes but simply is.

Dear mother, you too were yielding to this supreme love act and we all love you for it.

Even though we are hindered by our pettiness from doing so, we acknowledge you as Queen of Heaven, Queen of the angels and our great intercessor always in union with your son Jesus the greatest of all lovers, one with the Father and Holy Spirit for all time. Praise God.

Chapter 15

Trinity

Always You and I. All of us.

Dear Lord Jesus, one comes to the Father through You. It is the Father who is always giving, caring, looking after us yet we are commanded to approach Him through You.

This often impresses me as it is such a regal and courteous gesture. We approach the King of the Heavens through Jesus in Us. So in one sense Jesus, always when we think we are moving it is You moving in Us towards the Fatherhood of Almighty God. The Spirit activating and prompting Perpetual Trinity moving in Trinity to Trinity.

All of us, more closely caught up in Heavenly places than we dare realise for fear of being overawed by the magnitude of Your supreme response to your creation.

Chapter 16

Jesus and Everyday Life

Dear Jesus, so many distractions, so many thoughts, but thank you for always staying with me regardless.

The past six weeks have been amazing Jesus. Really You are here. I often wonder what would happen to our marriage were it not for You.

Dear Ursula, Eternal Father, how well you have brought her into your place of light Jesus. Gone are those days of tortuous deliberating of profundity gathered from books. It is so much more to the point to be with You, Jesus, simply in all our every-day functions.

Harvest

You promised to help us make a painting out of the house Jesus, and I can see You are at work. We manage to find all we need at no great cost and always you direct me to the place selling them. Jesus, it is good to have you in every aspect of our life. You are very much part of our marriage.

Sometimes I think of You being alongside us as we walk along the beautiful towpath. What a joy to see the magnificence of your gifts. Everything there to create colour and joy.

What a generous lover you are Lord. Reminds me of the gallant who goes to see his lady love with a bunch of flowers. With You Lord, it was the gift of mother earth in all its amazing robes of intricate, splendid colour. You must have known moments of staleness, Jesus. Or were You so caught up in a reality which evades us that your being was permanently in a state of growth that is fusing eternally?

I listen to some of our friends, Jesus, talking about Your humanity and Your temptations and get the impression that they have convinced themselves that they fully realise your humanity. Does anyone know what it is to be a real man? Was there ever a man with such an ability to merge

humanity and divinity as you Jesus? Certainly not! You are our aspiration, our hope, our glimmer of You is a mere ripple in a vast ocean of love.

Thank you Jesus, thank you for all our hope in You. If in any way we realised Your nearness

Chapter 17

The Cross and Moving On

The cross, dear Lord, has to be carried and always we are so busy convincing ourselves of all the valid excuses for delaying Your call.

Where can we hide? Not from that deep inner voice, eternally obedient to Your Will, feeling the need to respond to Your summons to move on. Jesus, you who understand our fears and doubts, must surely appreciate the fragility and exquisite bond which soothingly draws us to giving ourselves completely to Your love.

Your eternal plan Lord, so mysteriously divine in all its seemingly interweaving complexities.

Our hearts and minds yearningly grope for this freedom which has its existence in our being and yet somewhere we have lost ourselves to the symbolism of bird and cage.

How refreshing, Jesus, to continually remind oneself that you too had all the longing to be eternally productive and yet must have sensed the inner rebellion of flesh, suggesting a more perfect course thoroughly caught up in the Father's infinite goodness.

A hesitation Jesus, a moment's fatigue, all so infinitely

precious to the father, all abandoned to His Will. Lord, even exhaustion must express itself and realise the newness of the moment by its presence.

We cannot escape from sensing these human aspects of our being yet we must recognise that in rejoicing in them, we satisfy the fullness of the need of the moment. We cannot endlessly try to escape the beauty of Your presence in Our sufferings Jesus.

Each moment is the eternal blossoming of some preciousness so rare that to try to escape is to tear ourselves away from Your fashioning hands.

How You must gaze tenderly on this masterpiece of life Father and yearn that Your children be still and allow You to rule. You Father, the king of all time, the giver of all good thought and expression, permanently hindered and recreating in the basic panic - bursting of the dam of Your gracious giving. A thought Lord, which leaves me startled and amazed by its very reality.

Chapter 18

Being Alone with Jesus

I was wondering about the many moments of time I have spent just being alone with You, incapable of even thinking coherently. Many a time one has been caught up in a feeling of utter desolation and meaninglessness and I have often wanted to put into words exactly what I was then doing.

It is very simple. I was sharing my suffering with You Lord. More often I have nothing else to offer You, yet even the act of giving that to you Lord, has a sweetness and gentleness of its own.

We can only know the answer to the moment as You reveal it and how You replace suffering with joy, received from the giving of it.

Thank you Jesus, I beg you Lord to love me, as I know You do, but please bear with me the many mistakes I make - my inability to be holy.

Image of the Sacred Heart of Jesus

Somehow I feel in Your heart You must have a place for the unorthodox Davids of this world. I cannot ever see myself as the fine example some of your dear friends have been but please Lord, worthless as I am, take the hypocrite, the coward and the cheat and breathe Your own brand of transforming love since I know not what I should be like and wish only to be what You would have me be.

Lord, even if that is lacking in honesty, transform me and let me be pleasing to Your Spirit Jesus. I am what I am and even that, only You really understand since the state of being can only be perfected in You.

Grasp me and hold me. Touch me and love me Lord. I am weak and cannot cope but I will move on, never looking back.

Let my heart sing a new song. Let it blend in the Song of Love, the song You first sang Father, the life you gave us.

Praise you Father, Son and Holy Spirit.